



THE COCKPIT

As built, the Cub was fitted with minimal instrumentation—even the compass was an optional extra, and Piper's pilots were fined the \$12 cost of the item if they failed to return with it from deliveries to customers who had not paid up. While there was a steel firewall between engine and cockpit, the Cub's main fuel tank sat just behind the instrument panel, above the front-seated passenger or student's legs.

14. Instrument panel 15. Compass, mounted well away from steel structure 16. Slip ball (helped pilot keep aircraft in balance) 17. Airspeed indicator 18. Altimeter and Vertical Speed Indicator 19. Cold-start primer 20. Control stick and (on floor) heel-operated brake pedals



THE INTERIOR

A utilitarian product of the Depression era, the interior of the Piper J3 Cub was produced with little in the way of creature comforts for its occupants. The cabin walls were plain, doped fabric and the thinly upholstered seats were barely comfortable enough for a person to spend a couple of hours in the air—which was in any event the J3's normal duration. For center of gravity reasons, the aircraft had to be flown solo from the rear seat, which was set a little higher in the cockpit to give the pilot a better view past the passenger or student sat in front.

21. Magneto (ignition) key 22. Carburettor heat control (hot air from around exhaust was used to counter icing) 23. Throttle lever, one for each cockpit position 24. Trim handle 25. Upper door stay 26. Exposed wing main spar fitting 27. Drop-down door (right side only) and tandem seating

